

User Guide: Staff (Admin)

This guide explains how to use the platform as **Staff** (admin): managing users, farmer groups, aggregation centres, locations, commodity approvals, activity logs, analytics, and reports.

1. Logging in

1. Open the platform in your browser and go to **Login**.
2. Enter your **phone** (or email) and **password** (staff/admin credentials).
3. Click **Sign in**. You are taken to **My Dashboard** (staff); the sidebar shows the full admin menu.

2. Main menu and navigation

After login, the sidebar shows:

Menu item	Path / Purpose
My Dashboard	Overview of platform activity and metrics
Users	Create, edit, and manage all user accounts; bulk upload farmers
Commodity approval	Approve or reject produce listings (same as lead farmer)
Farmer Groups	Create and manage farmer groups
Aggregation Centers	Create and manage aggregation centres
Locations	Manage location hierarchy (counties, sub-counties, wards, villages)
Activity Logs	View system activity and audit logs
Analytics	Platform-wide analytics and visualizations
Reports	Generate and view staff reports

Use the **menu icon** on small screens to open or close the sidebar.

3. Users (user management)

Essence: Users is where you **manage everyone on the platform**: create accounts (single or bulk CSV upload), set roles and profiles, reset passwords, and suspend or reactivate users. It's the control point for who can use the system and how they're classified (farmer, buyer, officer, etc.).

Flow: List users → **Create single user or bulk upload farmers** → **Edit/disable/reset password as needed**.

1. Go to **Users** in the sidebar.
2. You see a **list of users** (table or cards). Each row may show name, email/phone, role, status, and last activity.
3. Use **filters** (e.g. role: Farmer, Buyer, Staff; status: Active, Inactive) and **search** (name, email, phone) to find users.
4. **Create a single user:**
 - Click **Add user** (or **Create user**). In the form, enter:
 - **Email** and/or **phone** (as required)
 - **Password**
 - **Role**: Farmer, Lead Farmer, Buyer, Extension Officer, Staff, Aggregation Manager, Input Provider, Transport Provider
 - **Profile**: first name, last name, and optionally county, sub-county, ward, village, farmer group, aggregation centre (for managers), or assigned county/sub-county (for officers)
 - Save. The user is created and can log in. If the platform is configured to send welcome messages, they may receive password or account details by SMS or email.
5. **Bulk upload farmers (CSV):**
 - Click **Bulk upload** (or similar) and **Download CSV template**. The template has columns such as: first_name, last_name, gender, phone, password, email, county, subcounty, ward, village. Fill in **one row per farmer**; leave email empty if the farmer has no email (no fake email is generated). Passwords can be left blank to have a default generated and sent via SMS/email if configured.
 - Click **Upload** and select your filled CSV file. The platform processes each row and shows a result: **Created** count, **Failed** count, and **Row errors** (row number and message for each failure). Fix errors in the CSV and re-upload failed rows if needed.
6. **Edit user:** Open a user from the list. Change **profile** (name, location), **role**, or **status**. Save.
7. **Reset password:** Open the user → click **Reset password** (or similar) → enter the new password and confirm. The user can then sign in with the new password.

8. **Disable or suspend:** Open the user → set **status** to Inactive or Suspended. Save. They can no longer log in until you reactivate them.

4. Commodity approval (listings)

Essence: **Commodity approval** lets you **approve or reject** produce listings (same as lead farmers). Use it when you need to clear the queue, override, or support lead farmers—so only suitable listings go live on the marketplace.

Flow: Open **Commodity approval** → **See pending listings** → **Open listing** → **Approve or Reject (with reason)**.

1. Go to **Commodity approval** in the sidebar (same screen as lead farmer **Approvals**, path: /dashboard/lead-farmer).
2. You see **pending** produce listings (status: **Pending lead approval**) in a list. Each may show variety, quantity, grade, farmer, location, and expected ready date.
3. Click a listing to open it and review full details (variety, grade, quantity, location, expected ready date, optional price and images).
4. Decide:
 - **Approve:** Click **Approve**. The listing becomes **ACTIVE** and appears on the buyer marketplace. The farmer is notified.
 - **Reject:** Click **Reject** and enter a **reason** (e.g. “Incorrect grade”, “Missing location”). The listing goes to **Revision requested**; the farmer is notified and can edit and resubmit.
5. After you approve or reject, the listing disappears from the pending list. Repeat for other pending listings.

5. Farmer Groups

Essence: **Farmer Groups** is where you **create and maintain groups** (e.g. cooperatives, village groups) and assign farmers to them. Groups are used for targeting advisories, reporting, and organisation—so extension and analytics can work at group level.

Flow: **Create group** → **Set name, code, location** → **Save** → **Assign farmers via Users or from group**.

1. Go to **Farmer Groups** in the sidebar.

2. You see a **list of existing groups**. Each may show name, code, location, and member count.
3. **Create** a new group: click **Add group** (or similar). Enter **name**, **code** (unique), and optionally **location** (e.g. sub-county, ward). Save.
4. **Edit** or **view** a group: open it to see details and optionally **member list**. To **assign farmers** to the group, go to **Users** → open each farmer → set **farmer group** to this group; or if the group page allows, add members from a list of farmers.
5. Use groups when **sending advisories** (Extension Officer: target by farmer group) or in **reports** that break down by group.

6. Aggregation Centers

Essence: **Aggregation Centers** is where you **register and configure** centres (name, location, type, capacity, manager). Centres are where farmers deliver and buyers are served; assigning managers here ties the right users to the right centre.

Flow: **Create centre** → **Set name, location, type, capacity** → **Save** → **Assign manager in Users**.

1. Go to **Aggregation Centers** in the sidebar.
2. You see a **list of centres**. Each may show name, location, type (main/satellite), capacity, status, and manager.
3. **Create** a centre: click **Add centre** (or similar). Enter **name**, **location** (e.g. ward, sub-county), **type** (main or satellite; satellite may link to a main centre), **capacity** if applicable, and optionally **status**. Save.
4. **Edit** or **view** a centre: open it to change details. To **assign a manager**, go to **Users** → create or edit a user with role **Aggregation Manager** → set **aggregation centre** to this centre. That user will then see the centre in their dashboard and manage stock in/out, order processing, etc.
5. Deleting a centre may be restricted if it has linked data (e.g. stock, orders); check the UI or contact support.

7. Locations (hierarchy)

Essence: **Locations** is where you **maintain the geography** of the platform: counties, sub-counties, wards, villages. Farmers, centres, and advisories all use this hierarchy; keeping it correct ensures bulk uploads, filters, and targeting work as expected. Deleting a parent cascades to its children.

Flow: Add county → Add sub-counties under county → Add wards under sub-county → Add villages under ward. Names are normalized (e.g. title case).

1. Go to **Locations** in the sidebar.
2. You see the **location hierarchy** in tabs or sections: **Counties, Sub-counties, Wards, Villages**. Names are **normalized** (e.g. “KANGUNDO” becomes “Kangundo”) for consistent matching in bulk upload and filters.
3. **Create a county:** Open **Counties** → **Add county**. Enter **name** (e.g. Machakos) and optional **code**. Save.
4. **Create a sub-county:** Open **Sub-counties** → **Add sub-county**. Enter **name** and select **county**. Save.
5. **Create a ward:** Open **Wards** → **Add ward**. Enter **name** and select **sub-county**. Save.
6. **Create a village:** Open **Villages** → **Add village**. Enter **name** and select **ward**. Save.
7. **Edit** or **delete** a location: open it and update or delete. **Deleting a parent** (e.g. a ward) **cascades** to its children (e.g. villages under that ward). Use with care.
8. Use this so that **farmers** (and bulk CSV), **centres**, and **advisories** can be assigned to the correct locations. If a location is missing, bulk upload or targeting by location may fail.

8. Activity Logs

Essence: Activity Logs show **who did what and when** (e.g. logins, order changes, approvals). Use them for support, disputes, and auditing—so you can trace actions and keep the platform accountable.

Flow: Open Activity Logs → Filter by user, action, date → View entries.

1. Go to **Activity Logs** in the sidebar.
2. You see **recent activity** in a list or table: e.g. user, action (login, order created, listing approved), timestamp, and optional details (IP, resource ID).
3. Use **filters** (user, action type, date range) if available to find specific events. Use for **support** (e.g. “Did this user place the order?”), **disputes**, and **auditing**.

9. Analytics and Reports

Essence: Analytics and **Reports** give you **platform-wide** metrics and exportable reports (users, orders, listings, revenue, growth). Use them to monitor health, report to stakeholders, and make data-

driven decisions.

Flow: Open Analytics or Reports → Select view or report → Apply filters → Export/print if needed.

1. **Analytics:** Go to **Analytics** in the sidebar. You see **platform-wide** charts and metrics, e.g.:

- User growth (by role, over time)
- Orders and revenue
- Listings (active, pending)
- Activity by location or period

Use **date range** and **filters** as needed. Use for **monitoring** and **reporting to stakeholders**.

2. **Reports:** Go to **Reports** in the sidebar. **Generate or view** staff reports (e.g. user growth, commodity approval queue, locations, farmer groups). Select report type and filters, then view or **export** (CSV, PDF) or **print** if supported.

10. Notifications and profile

- **Notifications** (bell icon or in-app) may alert you to critical platform events. Open them to go to the relevant screen.
- Use **Settings** or **Profile** (if available) to update your admin details or password.

11. Quick reference: key flows

Goal	Steps
Add one farmer	Users → Add user → Set role Farmer + profile (name, location, etc.) → Save
Add many farmers	Users → Download CSV template → Fill rows → Upload CSV → Check Created/Failed and row errors → Fix and re-upload if needed
Approve listings	Commodity approval → Open pending listing → Approve or Reject with reason
Add farmer group	Farmer Groups → Add group → Name, code, location → Save → Assign farmers in Users

Goal	Steps
Add centre	Aggregation Centers → Add centre → Name, location, type, capacity → Save → Assign manager in Users
Add location	Locations → Add county/sub-county/ward/village under parent → Save (names normalized)
Audit	Activity Logs → Filter by user/action/date → View entries
Report	Analytics or Reports → Select view/report → Apply filters → Export/print if needed

For **extension officers** (advisories, farmers by location, quality standards), see [User Guide: Extension Officer](#).